

The Viral Video Breakdown System

The exact prompts I use to pull the hook, storytelling, and visual layout out of any video, then spot the trend across several of them.

Why I built this

I kept watching videos three or four times, feeling like I understood why they worked, then making something that didn't land the same way. Watching and breaking down are two different skills, and I wasn't doing the second one on purpose.

So I built Niche Pulse, one of fifteen AI systems inside Growth OS, the app I run my own content research through. You drop in a video link and get the transcript, the hook structure, the storytelling, and the visual layout, split apart instead of blurred into one impression.

This guide is the manual version. You don't need Growth OS to use it, just Claude and a transcript. The promise is simple: one video, broken into three parts you can actually study and reuse.

It's slower than dropping a link into a tool, but it teaches you the same categories a tool would use, which means you start noticing hooks and story beats on your own, without running every video through Claude first.

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How it actually works

1. Paste a video's transcript into Claude and ask it to separate the hook, the storytelling structure, and the visual layout into three labeled sections.
2. Do the same breakdown for three to five other videos in the same niche, keeping the labels identical each time so the results line up.
3. Lay the breakdowns side by side and ask Claude what repeats across all of them. That repeat is the trend, not any single video.

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The one thing almost everyone gets wrong

People analyze one video, decide it's a fluke or a formula, and stop there. A single video only tells you what one creator chose to do.

WATCH OUT

A real trend only shows up once you compare three to five videos in the same category, broken down the same way. If you skip the comparison step, you're copying a guess, not following a pattern.

BREAK DOWN ONE VIDEO

Here is the transcript of a video: [PASTE TRANSCRIPT]. Separate it into three labeled sections: HOOK (the first 1–3 seconds and why it earns attention), STORYTELLING (the order ideas are introduced, the tension, the payoff), and VISUAL LAYOUT (based on this description of what's on screen: [PASTE VISUAL NOTES]). Don't guess at anything I haven't given you.

COMPARE SEVERAL VIDEOS

Here are breakdowns of [NUMBER] videos in the [NICHE] niche, each with a HOOK, STORYTELLING, and VISUAL LAYOUT section: [PASTE ALL BREAKDOWNS]. What repeats across all or most of them in each category? Call out anything that appears in only one video separately from anything that appears in several.

REMAKE THE PATTERN

Using this hook pattern: [PASTE HOOK PATTERN FROM THE COMPARISON], write three opening lines for a video about [YOUR TOPIC]. Then map this story beat order: [PASTE BEAT ORDER] onto my own point: [YOUR POINT], keeping the same sequence but my own words.

DESCRIBE THE VISUAL LAYOUT BY HAND

I'm going to describe what's on screen in a video, second by second, and I want you to use it as the VISUAL LAYOUT section of a breakdown. Here's what I saw: [DESCRIBE WHAT TEXT APPEARS AND WHEN, WHERE CUTS HAPPEN, WHAT'S ON SCREEN DURING THE HOOK VS. THE REST]. Turn this into 2–4 sentences covering pacing and on-screen text timing.

Set it up yourself

1. Open Claude (claude.ai or Claude Code) and start a fresh chat or project for your video research, so the breakdowns don't get mixed in with other work.
2. Get the transcript of the video you want to break down. YouTube has a 'Show transcript' option under the description. TikTok and Instagram auto-generate captions you can turn on and copy out by hand if there's no direct export.
3. If you can't get a clean transcript, watch the video once and type out what's said yourself. It takes a few minutes and the breakdown is only as good as the text you give Claude.
4. Run the 'Break down one video' prompt above with that transcript pasted in. Save the three-part result somewhere you'll come back to, like a doc or a notes app.
5. Repeat for three to five more videos in the same niche. Keep the HOOK / STORYTELLING / VISUAL LAYOUT labels identical every time.
6. Run the 'Compare several videos' prompt with all the breakdowns pasted in, then use the 'Remake the pattern' prompt on whatever repeats.

 QUICK TIPS

- If you're doing this often, save the three prompts as a Claude Project's custom instructions so you're not retyping them.
- A plain text file per video (transcript plus breakdown) is enough. You don't need a database for five videos.

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The commands I actually run

FIRST PASS ON A NEW VIDEO

Transcript: [PASTE]. Give me HOOK, STORYTELLING, VISUAL LAYOUT as three short labeled sections, each 2–4 sentences, based only on what I've pasted.

CHECK IF I ACTUALLY HAVE A TREND YET

Here are [NUMBER] breakdowns: [PASTE]. Is [NUMBER] enough to call something a trend, or do I need more examples? Tell me honestly, don't just agree with me.

SANITY-CHECK A REMAKE BEFORE I FILM IT

Here's the original hook pattern: [PASTE]. Here's my remake: [PASTE YOUR VERSION]. Did I copy specific wording or footage, or did I only reuse the structure? Flag anything too close to the original.

When it breaks

ERROR	FIX
Claude says it can't open the video link	Paste the transcript text directly. Claude can't watch video files, only read what you give it.
The breakdown feels generic or could apply to any video	You pasted a summary instead of the actual transcript. Paste the real text, even if it's long.
Claude describes visuals it couldn't have seen	You didn't give it visual notes. Either paste a description of what's on screen or tell it to skip the VISUAL LAYOUT section.
The comparison step contradicts itself between videos	Check that every breakdown used the same three labels in the same order. Mismatched labels confuse the comparison.
You only have one or two videos and Claude is already calling something a trend	Tell it directly: wait, don't call a pattern yet, I only have [NUMBER] examples. Push for at least three before trusting the result.
Your remake feels too close to the original	Ask the sanity-check prompt above before you film. If it flags specific wording or footage, change that part and keep only the structure.
The hook pattern doesn't fit your topic at all	Not every pattern transfers. If three rewrites still feel forced, that hook belongs to a different kind of video than the one you're making.

Ready to go deeper?

This playbook is the short version. Inside the hub you get the full build walkthroughs, the prompt library, and the systems I use to ship this in a weekend.

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